



STORY MATH ADVENTURES!



Solving Word Problems with 4 Magic Steps



Hey Little Mathematician! Did you know that every math word problem is just a fun story with secret numbers hidden inside? Let's learn the clues to unlock them!



The 4 Magic Steps

1

UNDERSTAND

What is the story? What numbers do you see?

2

PLAN

Find the clue words! Do we ADD (+) or SUBTRACT (-)?

3

SOLVE

Write your number sentence and do the math!

4

CHECK

Does your answer make sense in the story?



Secret Clue Word Detective Card



ADDITION CLUES

altogether

total

in all

more than

plus

combined

both



SUBTRACT CLUES

left

remaining

fewer

took away

spent

gave away

ate



Let's Look at Examples!



Example 1: Mango Fun

Meera wants 7 mangoes. Rohan wants 5 more. How many mangoes altogether?

1. UNDERSTAND

Numbers: 7, 5

2. PLAN

"Altogether" means
ADD (+)

3. SOLVE

$7 + 5 = 12$ mangoes!

4. CHECK

12 is bigger than 7.
Makes sense!



Example 2: Diwali Chaklis

Grandma made 13 chaklis for Diwali. She made 6 more. How many chaklis in all?

1. UNDERSTAND

Numbers: 13, 6

2. PLAN

"In all" means
ADD (+)

3. SOLVE

$13 + 6 = 19$ chaklis!

4. CHECK

19 is more than 13.
Makes sense!



Example 3: Arjun's Pencils

Arjun had 17 pencils. He lost 5 at school. How many pencils does he have now?

1. UNDERSTAND

Numbers: 17, 5

2. PLAN

"Lost" means
SUBTRACT (-)

3. SOLVE

$17 - 5 = 12$ pencils!

4. CHECK

12 is smaller than 17.
Makes sense!



Blue Word Spotter Practice

Read the stories. Underline the clue words and pick the correct math sign!

Story A: Priya has 9 bangles. She got 4 more. How many altogether?



My Clue Words: _____ | Circle One: **+** (ADD) or **-** (SUBTRACT)

Story B: There were 18 idlis. The family ate 7. How many are left?

 My Clue Words: _____ |  Circle One: **+** (ADD) or **—** (SUBTRACT)



Practice Zone (Your Turn!)

Problem 1

Amma cooked 20 chapatis for dinner. The family ate 13 chapatis. How many chapatis were left?

1 2
3 4

Numbers I see: _ _ _ _ _



Clue word: _ _ _ _ _ → Do we **+** or **-**?

Write your number sentence and solve here:



Final Answer: _ _ _ _ _ chapatis

Problem 2

There are 11 girls and 7 boys in Kavya's class today. How many children are in the class altogether?

1 2
3 4

Numbers I see: _ _ _ _ _



Clue word: _ _ _ _ _ → Do we **+** or **-**?

Write your number sentence and solve here:



Final Answer: _ _ _ _ _ children



Exit Ticket Quiz

Riya had 16 stickers. She gave 7 to her friend. Circle the number sentence that tells the story perfectly:

★ A) $16 + 7 = 23$

★ B) $16 - 7 = 9$

★ C) $7 - 16 = ?$



Fun Home Challenge!

Be a Story Creator tonight! Write your very own word problem using something in your house (like toys, fruits, or family members). Bring it tomorrow to challenge your best friend!

Write or draw your home story here...